

Agents: Observe, Decide, Act

1 An agent is a loop

Observe the situation, decide what to do, act, observe what happened. Repeat until done.

2 Tools are how it acts

The model names a tool and its arguments; your code runs it and hands back the result. Keep the acting in your code.

3 Most steps are decisions

In our SOC agent: 5.3 small typed decisions per alert, 0.3 pieces of free text.

4 Errors compound

95% right per step sounds good. Ten steps in a row: 60%. Twenty: 36%.

5 Latency compounds too

With illustrative numbers, making each decision with an LLM call took 7.3 s per alert; with a fast decision model 2.2 s.

6 Stopping is a decision

“Do we have enough evidence?” decides cost, speed and quality. Give it a budget and a threshold.